speak the main north Indian dialect. The local peasantry (from the same ethnic group) are deemed to speak a language unrelated to 'Hindoostanee'. This fits what we already know. The elite in the old Arakan kingdom had close political, cultural and ethnic ties with Bengal, and easily spoke a variant of Bengali. Their peasantry spoke the local Rohingya language, which provides further proof that a large Muslim community was living in Arakan by the start of the nineteenth century and that this had long been linguistically distinct from northern India.

When Burma became an administrative unit distinct from India in 1937, the British commissioned a report looking at population changes in the region since 1872.[72] This report, written by James Baxter, focused on the question of whether or not Indian migration had reduced employment opportunities for the local Burmese population. Baxter's report involved, for example, reclassifying the 1871 census figures such that the Hindu population in Arakan was identified as Indian in origin (having migrated in search of work under British rule). It also made an effort to distinguish between the various Muslim communities in the province as opposed to simply combining them by religious affiliation. From this, Baxter acknowledged that,

> there was an Arakanese Muslim community settled so long in Akyab District that it had for all intents and purposes to be regarded as an indigenous race. There were also a *few* Mohamedan Kamans in Arakan and a small but long established Muslim community around Moulmen which could not be regarded as Indian.[73]

I emphasise the word 'few' since it is important. The British census is clear that there were three Muslim groups: the Kamans, a group living in Akyab (the Rohingyas), and a small community at Moulmen. Baxter adds that it would be incorrect to 'assume that all the … Mohamedans were Indian'.

Derek Tonkin has claimed that the Rohingyas are not among the communities of 'long established' Muslims, since Baxter did not use the term "Rohingya" to refer to the Arakan Muslims. He adds that 'at no stage during their administration of Arakan from its capture in 1825 to independence in 1948 did the British even once use the designation "Rohingya" to describe these communities'.[74] It is true that Baxter does not use the word 'Rohingya' but, as we have shown, there are plenty of examples of this name being used both before and during the colonial period. As discussed, the British censuses were done in the interests of the